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40 RECIPES + 4 PLANNING LESSONS

# Celebration Cakes for Every Occasion

40 Cakes for Birthdays, Holidays, and Milestone Celebrations

NATURAL WELLNESS LIBRARY

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Celebration Cakes for Every Occasion

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This book is sold for personal use. Recipes are provided for home baking; please check your own equipment, ingredient brands, and altitude, as results can vary. These recipes are based on standard baking and pastry ratios, not on documented testing of every recipe in this book. Scaled-up and multi-tier recipes should be measured carefully, since small errors compound at larger volumes.

Always check ingredient labels for allergens before serving to guests.

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PART 1

# Planning a Celebration Cake

Four lessons covering sizing and planning, layering and stacking, safe transport, and storage timelines for any celebration cake.

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## Planning and Sizing a Celebration Cake

Start from the guest count, not the recipe. A 9-inch round two-layer cake serves about 12-14 people cut into standard party slices; an 8-inch round serves about 10-12. For larger gatherings, a two-tier cake (e.g., 9-inch base with a 6-inch top tier) can serve 30-40, since the serving count scales with surface area, not visually with height.

Work backwards from your date: most celebration cakes can have their sponge layers baked and frozen (well-wrapped) up to a month ahead, frosted and assembled 1-2 days ahead, and decorated the day of or the day before. This spreads the work out and reduces day-of stress.

Account for dietary needs early, not as an afterthought — if you need a nut-free or dairy-free version, check the allergen notes on your chosen recipe before you shop, since substitutions can change baking times.

- 9-inch 2-layer round: about 12-14 servings
- 8-inch 2-layer round: about 10-12 servings
- Two-tier (9-inch + 6-inch): about 30-40 servings
- Bake and freeze sponge layers weeks ahead; frost 1-2 days ahead; decorate last

## Layering, Leveling, and Stacking Tiers

Level each cooled layer with a long serrated knife before stacking, so the finished cake sits flat rather than leaning. A thin crumb coat of frosting seals in loose crumbs — chill it for 15-20 minutes before applying the final, thicker coat.

For a stacked multi-tier cake, insert support dowels (wooden or plastic) into the bottom tier before placing the next tier on top, so the upper tier's weight doesn't compress the layers below it. A thin cake board under each tier also helps distribute weight evenly.

Always work on a turntable if you have one — it makes smoothing sides and piping borders far more even than turning the cake by hand.

- Level layers with a serrated knife before stacking
- Crumb coat first, chill, then apply the final coat
- Use support dowels under any tier that carries another tier's weight
- A cake board under each tier distributes weight evenly

## Transporting a Celebration Cake Safely

Chill the finished cake thoroughly before transport — a firm, cold cake holds its shape far better in a moving vehicle than a soft, room-temperature one. Place it on a non-slip mat (a damp towel or shelf liner works) in the flattest part of the car, usually the floor of the back seat or trunk, not the seat itself where it can slide.

Keep the air conditioning on in warm weather, especially for anything with buttercream or whipped cream, which soften quickly above about 75F/24C.

For longer trips, consider transporting the tiers separately (unstacked, each on its own board, boxed) and assembling at the venue — this is far safer than moving a fully stacked multi-tier cake any real distance.

- Chill thoroughly before the drive — cold cakes hold shape better
- Place on a non-slip surface on the flattest part of the vehicle
- Keep cool air on in warm weather
- For long trips, transport tiers separately and assemble on site

## Storage and Make-Ahead Timeline

Buttercream- and ganache-frosted cakes can sit at cool room temperature for several hours for serving, but should be refrigerated for longer storage, especially in warm weather or with cream cheese or whipped cream components, which must be refrigerated.

Bring a refrigerated cake back toward room temperature for about 30-45 minutes before serving — cold butter in frosting tastes dull and firm; it softens and tastes best nearer room temperature.

Unfrosted sponge layers freeze very well, wrapped tightly in plastic wrap and then foil, for up to a month — this is the single best way to get ahead on a big celebration cake without any loss of quality.

- Buttercream/ganache cakes: a few hours at room temp is fine, refrigerate for longer storage
- Cream cheese and whipped cream finishes must be refrigerated
- Let a chilled cake sit out 30-45 minutes before serving
- Unfrosted sponge layers freeze well for up to a month

PART 2

# Birthday Cakes

Eight full-size birthday cakes, from a dependable vanilla base to a frozen ice cream cake and a surprise-inside piñata design.

## Classic Birthday Vanilla Layer Cake

*A dependable vanilla layer cake sized for a real party, finished with vanilla buttercream and sprinkles.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 28-32 MIN • CHILL NONE • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/2 cups (500g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and milk, starting and ending with flour.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-32 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then level, fill, stack, and frost with vanilla buttercream (see Decorating Handbook).

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days; bring to room temperature before serving.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

## Funfetti Birthday Cake

*A full-size version of the funfetti cupcake, studded with sprinkles for a classic kids' party look.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 28-32 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/2 cups (500g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 2/3 cup (115g) rainbow jimmies sprinkles

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and milk, then gently fold in the sprinkles.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-32 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost and decorate with more sprinkles pressed onto the sides.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Chocolate Birthday Cake

*A full-size chocolate layer cake, deep and moist from the hot-coffee method, for chocolate-loving crowds.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (65g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 1/4 tsp baking soda
- 1 1/8 tsp baking powder
- 1 1/8 tsp salt
- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) buttermilk
- 9 tbsp (135ml) vegetable oil
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) hot coffee

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, sugar, cocoa, baking soda, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Add the eggs, buttermilk, and oil, whisk smooth, then stir in the hot coffee (the batter will be thin).
4. Divide between the pans and bake 30-34 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
5. Cool completely, then frost with chocolate buttercream or ganache.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Rainbow Layer Birthday Cake

*A vanilla base split and tinted into bright colored layers for a dramatic sliced cross-section.*

PREP 35 MIN • BAKE 18-20 MIN PER LAYER • FOUR 6-INCH ROUND PANS (OR TWO PANS, BAKED TWICE) • 350F/175C • 14-16 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/2 cups (500g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- Gel food coloring in 4 colors

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease four 6-inch pans (or bake in batches).
2. Make the vanilla batter as in the standard recipe.
3. Divide the batter evenly into 4 bowls and tint each a different color with gel food coloring.
4. Pour each color into its own pan and bake 18-20 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
5. Cool completely, then stack the colored layers with white frosting between each, so the color shows when sliced.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Cookies and Cream Birthday Cake

*A full-size vanilla cake with crushed sandwich cookies folded in, frosted with cookies-and-cream buttercream.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 28-32 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 20 chocolate sandwich cookies, crushed

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and milk, then fold in the crushed cookies.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-32 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with a buttercream mixed with more crushed cookies.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Number or Letter Cake

*A sheet cake baked flat, then cut with a template into a number or initial for milestone birthdays.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 25-28 MIN • 9X13-INCH PAN, CUT TO SHAPE • 350F/175C • 12-16 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/2 cups (500g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour a 9×13-inch pan.
2. Make the batter as in the standard vanilla recipe and pour into the pan.
3. Bake 25-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean. Cool completely, then chill 30 minutes to firm up for cleaner cutting.
4. Print or draw a number/letter template the size of the pan, lay it over the cake, and cut around it with a sharp knife.
5. Frost the cut shape, piecing together any separate sections with a thin layer of frosting to hold them in place.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Ice Cream Birthday Cake

*A baked cake base topped with a thick layer of softened ice cream, frozen solid, then finished with whipped cream.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 25-28 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT (FREEZER) • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 350F/175C • 12 SERVINGS

- 1 batch chocolate or vanilla cake batter, baked in one 9-inch springform layer
- 1.5 quarts (1.4L) softened ice cream, any flavor
- 1 batch Whipped Cream Frosting (see Decorating Handbook)

### METHOD

1. Bake one 9-inch cake layer as directed and cool completely. Wipe out the springform pan and return the cooled cake layer to it.
2. Spread the softened ice cream evenly over the cake layer, staying inside the pan.
3. Freeze until completely solid, at least 6 hours or overnight.
4. Release the springform ring, frost the top and sides with whipped cream frosting, and return to the freezer until ready to serve.
5. Move to the refrigerator 15-20 minutes before serving to make slicing easier.

**Storage:** Keep frozen; best within 1 week.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

## Surprise-Inside Piñata Birthday Cake

*A vanilla layer cake with a hidden cavity of candy in the center layer, revealed when the first slice is cut.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 28-32 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS (ONE WITH A CORED CENTER) • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/2 cups (500g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup small candies (such as small chocolates or mini gumballs), for the center

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Make the vanilla batter as in the standard recipe and divide between the pans.
3. Bake 28-32 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean. Cool completely.
4. Using a round cutter, cut a 4-5 inch circle out of the center of one layer, removing it carefully without cracking the ring that remains.
5. Place the whole layer on the cake board, top with the ring-shaped layer, and fill the cavity with candies.
6. Frost the assembled cake as usual, fully concealing the hidden center until cut.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy; candy fillings vary.

PART 3

# Classic Layer Cakes

Eight traditional layer cakes, the enduring favorites behind most celebration tables.

## Classic Yellow Layer Cake with Chocolate Frosting

*A tender, egg-yolk-rich yellow cake, the classic pairing for chocolate frosting.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 3/4 cups (345g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs plus 2 egg yolks
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 2 tsp vanilla extract

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs and yolks one at a time, then the vanilla.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and milk.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with chocolate buttercream or ganache.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# German Chocolate Layer Cake

*A mild chocolate cake, traditionally filled and topped with a cooked coconut-pecan filling.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

### CAKE

- 4 oz (113g) sweet baking chocolate, melted
- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 1 3/4 cups (350g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs, separated
- 1 cup (240ml) buttermilk
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/4 tsp salt

### COCONUT-PECAN FILLING

- 1 cup (240ml) evaporated milk
- 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar
- 3 egg yolks
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter
- 1 1/3 cups (115g) shredded coconut
- 1 cup (120g) chopped pecans

### METHOD

1. For the filling, whisk the evaporated milk, sugar, egg yolks, and butter in a saucepan over medium heat until thickened, about 10 minutes. Stir in the coconut and pecans and cool completely.
2. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the egg yolks one at a time, then the melted chocolate.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture (whisked with baking soda and salt) and buttermilk.
5. Whip the egg whites to stiff peaks and fold into the batter.
6. Divide between the pans and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
7. Cool completely, then spread the coconut-pecan filling between layers and on top (the sides are traditionally left unfrosted).

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and pecans.

# Classic Carrot Layer Cake

*A full-size version of the carrot cupcake, spiced and finished with cream cheese frosting.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/2 cups (310g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (240ml) vegetable oil
- 4 large eggs
- 3 cups finely grated carrots
- 1 cup (120g) chopped walnuts
- 2 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking soda, baking powder, salt, and cinnamon together.
3. Whisk the oil, sugar, and eggs together, then fold in the dry ingredients, then the carrots and walnuts.
4. Divide between the pans and bake 30-34 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
5. Cool completely, then frost with cream cheese frosting.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and walnuts.

# Classic Red Velvet Layer Cake

*A full-size red velvet, mild in chocolate flavor and tangy from buttermilk, with cream cheese frosting.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/2 cups (310g) all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups (300g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1/2 cup (120ml) vegetable oil
- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup (240ml) buttermilk
- 1 tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp white vinegar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 tsp red food coloring

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, cocoa, baking soda, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter, oil, and sugar until fluffy, then add the eggs.
4. Mix the buttermilk, vinegar, vanilla, and food coloring together, then alternate adding it with the flour mixture.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with cream cheese frosting.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Classic White Layer Cake

*A pure-white cake made with egg whites only, giving a bright white crumb under frosting or fondant.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) cake flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 6 large egg whites
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 tsp almond extract

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy. In a separate bowl, whisk the egg whites with the milk, vanilla, and almond extract.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and the egg-white mixture.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely before frosting — this cake's pale crumb makes it a good base for fondant or pastel buttercream.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and almond.

# Classic Marble Layer Cake

*Vanilla and chocolate batters swirled together for a two-tone slice.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 30-32 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/2 cups (500g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1/3 cup (30g) unsweetened cocoa powder mixed with 3 tbsp hot water

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Make the vanilla batter as in the standard recipe.
3. Remove about 1 1/2 cups of the batter to a separate bowl and stir in the cocoa paste.
4. Spoon alternating dollops of vanilla and chocolate batter into the pans, then swirl gently with a knife.
5. Bake 30-32 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely before frosting.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Classic Italian Cream Layer Cake

*A three-layer Southern classic with coconut and pecans folded into the batter, finished with cream cheese frosting.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • THREE 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 14-16 SERVINGS

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1/2 cup (120ml) vegetable oil
- 5 large eggs, separated
- 1 cup (240ml) buttermilk
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 cup (85g) shredded coconut
- 1 cup (120g) chopped pecans

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour three 9-inch pans.
2. Beat the butter, oil, and sugar until fluffy, add the egg yolks one at a time.
3. Alternate adding the flour (whisked with baking soda) and buttermilk, then fold in the coconut and pecans.
4. Whip the egg whites to stiff peaks and fold into the batter.
5. Divide among the pans and bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with cream cheese frosting.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and pecans.

# Classic Spice Layer Cake

*A warmly spiced layer cake good for fall celebrations, finished with brown-butter or cream cheese frosting.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) packed brown sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) buttermilk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp ground nutmeg
- 1/2 tsp ground ginger
- 1/4 tsp ground cloves

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, salt, and spices together.
3. Beat the butter and brown sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and buttermilk.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with brown-butter or cream cheese frosting.

**Storage:** Frosted, refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

PART 4

# Chocolate & Fruit Celebration Cakes

Eight cakes built around rich chocolate or real fruit flavor, from flourless chocolate to tropical pineapple-coconut.

## Flourless Chocolate Celebration Cake

*A dense, fudgy, naturally gluten-free cake good for a small, elegant gathering.*

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 35-40 MIN • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 325F/160C • 12 SERVINGS

- 10 oz (285g) semisweet chocolate, chopped
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 1 1/4 cups (250g) granulated sugar
- 5 large eggs
- 1/3 cup (30g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/4 tsp salt

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 325F/160C. Grease a 9-inch springform pan and line the bottom with parchment.
2. Melt the chocolate and butter together, stirring until smooth.
3. Whisk in the sugar, then the eggs one at a time, then the cocoa powder and salt.
4. Pour into the pan and bake 35-40 minutes, until the top looks set and a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
5. Cool completely in the pan, then release the ring. Dust with cocoa or top with a thin ganache glaze.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 5 days.

**Allergens:** Contains egg and dairy.

# Chocolate Raspberry Celebration Cake

*Chocolate layers filled with raspberry preserves and frosted with chocolate ganache.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

### CAKE

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (65g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 1/4 tsp baking soda
- 1 1/8 tsp baking powder
- 1 1/8 tsp salt
- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) buttermilk
- 9 tbsp (135ml) vegetable oil
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) hot coffee

### FILLING

- 3/4 cup (240g) seedless raspberry preserves

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Make the chocolate cake batter as in the standard recipe and divide between the pans.
3. Bake 30-34 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean. Cool completely.
4. Spread the raspberry preserves over the bottom layer, leaving a small border, then top with the second layer.
5. Frost the outside with chocolate ganache or buttercream.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Chocolate Orange Celebration Cake

*Fresh orange zest folded into a chocolate batter, a classic flavor pairing for an elegant dessert table.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (65g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 1/4 tsp baking soda
- 1 1/8 tsp baking powder
- 1 1/8 tsp salt
- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) buttermilk
- 9 tbsp (135ml) vegetable oil
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) hot coffee
- Zest of 2 oranges

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Make the chocolate cake batter as in the standard recipe, stirring the orange zest in with the eggs.
3. Divide between the pans and bake 30-34 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
4. Cool completely, then frost with chocolate ganache or orange-infused buttercream.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Strawberry Celebration Cake

*A pink-tinted cake made with real strawberry puree, finished with strawberry buttercream and fresh berries.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 cup (240g) strawberry puree (about 2 cups fresh strawberries, blended and strained)
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the strawberry puree.
4. Fold in the flour mixture just until combined.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with strawberry buttercream and top with fresh berries.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Lemon Raspberry Celebration Cake

*Bright lemon layers filled with raspberry preserves and lemon curd, a classic spring and summer pairing.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- Zest of 3 lemons
- 3 tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1/2 cup lemon curd and 1/2 cup raspberry preserves, for filling

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter, sugar, and lemon zest until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and milk mixed with lemon juice.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then fill with alternating swirls of lemon curd and raspberry preserves before frosting with vanilla buttercream.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Tropical Pineapple Coconut Celebration Cake

*A coconut-milk cake with crushed pineapple folded in, frosted with cream cheese frosting and toasted coconut.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 cup (240ml) coconut milk
- 1 cup (255g) crushed pineapple, well drained
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and coconut milk, then fold in the well-drained pineapple.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with cream cheese frosting and press toasted coconut onto the sides.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Black Forest Celebration Cake

*A full-size version of Black Forest cake — chocolate layers, cherry filling, and whipped cream.*

PREP 35 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • CHILL 1 HOUR • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

### CAKE

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (65g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 1/4 tsp baking soda
- 1 1/8 tsp baking powder
- 1 1/8 tsp salt
- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) buttermilk
- 9 tbsp (135ml) vegetable oil
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) hot coffee

### FILLING & TOPPING

- 2 cups pitted cherries, fresh or jarred, with 1/4 cup juice reserved
- 2 tbsp kirsch or cherry juice
- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, whipped with 3 tbsp powdered sugar
- Chocolate shavings, for garnish

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Bake the chocolate cake batter in two 9-inch pans as directed, 30-34 minutes. Cool completely.
2. Brush each layer with a little reserved cherry juice mixed with kirsch.
3. Spread a layer of whipped cream over the bottom layer, then arrange cherries over the cream, pressing in slightly.
4. Top with the second layer, then cover the whole cake in whipped cream.
5. Chill at least 1 hour to firm up, then garnish with chocolate shavings and more cherries before serving.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 3 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Chocolate Hazelnut Celebration Cake

*Chocolate layers filled and frosted with a chocolate-hazelnut buttercream, finished with chopped toasted hazelnuts.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (65g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 1/4 tsp baking soda
- 1 1/8 tsp baking powder
- 1 1/8 tsp salt
- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) buttermilk
- 9 tbsp (135ml) vegetable oil
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) hot coffee
- 1/2 cup chopped toasted hazelnuts, for garnish

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Make the chocolate cake batter as in the standard recipe and divide between the pans.
3. Bake 30-34 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean. Cool completely.
4. Frost with chocolate-hazelnut buttercream (fold 1/2 cup chocolate-hazelnut spread into a batch of chocolate buttercream).
5. Press chopped toasted hazelnuts onto the bottom edge of the cake for a finished border.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and hazelnuts.

PART 5

# Holiday & Seasonal Cakes

Eight cakes themed to specific holidays and seasons throughout the year.

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## Classic Christmas Spice Cake

*A molasses-warmed spice cake for winter holiday tables, finished with cream cheese frosting.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups (300g) packed brown sugar
- 1/2 cup (170g) molasses
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 cup (240ml) buttermilk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 tsp ground ginger
- 1/2 tsp ground cloves

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and spices together.
3. Beat the butter and brown sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the molasses.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and buttermilk.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with cream cheese frosting.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

## Peppermint Chocolate Holiday Cake

*Chocolate layers with a peppermint buttercream, topped with crushed candy canes for the holidays.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (65g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 1/4 tsp baking soda
- 1 1/8 tsp baking powder
- 1 1/8 tsp salt
- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) buttermilk
- 9 tbsp (135ml) vegetable oil
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) hot coffee
- 1/2 cup crushed candy canes, for garnish

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Make the chocolate cake batter as in the standard recipe and divide between the pans.
3. Bake 30-34 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean. Cool completely.
4. Frost with peppermint buttercream (add 1/2 tsp peppermint extract to a batch of vanilla buttercream).
5. Press crushed candy canes onto the top and bottom edge before serving.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Pumpkin Celebration Cake

*A full-size spiced pumpkin layer cake for fall gatherings, finished with cream cheese frosting.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) packed brown sugar
- 1 cup (240ml) vegetable oil
- 4 large eggs
- 1 3/4 cups (420g) pumpkin puree
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp ground ginger
- 1/4 tsp ground cloves

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and spices together.
3. Whisk the oil, brown sugar, and eggs together, then whisk in the pumpkin puree.
4. Fold in the flour mixture just until combined.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with cream cheese frosting.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Eggnog Holiday Cake

*A nutmeg-spiced cake made with real eggnog, good for winter holiday tables.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) prepared eggnog
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp ground nutmeg
- 1 tsp rum extract (optional)

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, salt, and nutmeg together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the rum extract if using.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and eggnog.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with eggnog-spiced buttercream (whisk 1/4 tsp nutmeg into vanilla buttercream).

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Valentine Red Velvet Heart Cake

*A classic trick for a heart-shaped cake without a special pan: one round layer cut in half, paired with a square layer.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • ONE 9-INCH ROUND PAN PLUS ONE 8-INCH SQUARE PAN (FOR THE HEART SHAPE) • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/2 cups (310g) all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups (300g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1/2 cup (120ml) vegetable oil
- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup (240ml) buttermilk
- 1 tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp white vinegar
- 2 tsp red food coloring

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease one 9-inch round pan and one 8-inch square pan.
2. Make the red velvet batter as in the standard recipe and divide between the two pans.
3. Bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean. Cool completely.
4. Cut the round layer in half. Place the square layer as a diamond (point facing you), then place the two round halves along the top two edges to form a heart.
5. Frost the assembled shape with cream cheese frosting, piecing the seams together with a thin layer first.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Easter Carrot Celebration Cake

*A spring version of the classic carrot cake, decorated with pastel buttercream and a nest of shredded coconut.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/2 cups (310g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (240ml) vegetable oil
- 4 large eggs
- 3 cups finely grated carrots
- 2 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 cup (85g) shredded coconut, tinted pale green, for garnish

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking soda, baking powder, salt, and cinnamon together.
3. Whisk the oil, sugar, and eggs together, then fold in the dry ingredients, then the grated carrots.
4. Divide between the pans and bake 30-34 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
5. Cool completely, then frost with cream cheese frosting and top with the tinted coconut 'nest' and small candy eggs.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Fourth of July Berry Cake

*A white cake finished with whipped cream and a red-white-blue arrangement of berries for summer holidays.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) cake flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 6 large egg whites
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 cups mixed strawberries and blueberries, for topping

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Make the white cake batter as in the standard recipe and divide between the pans.
3. Bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean. Cool completely.
4. Frost with whipped cream frosting.
5. Arrange sliced strawberries and blueberries in a flag-like pattern over the top just before serving.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 2 days (fresh fruit topping).

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Halloween Chocolate Spice Cake

*A chocolate-pumpkin spice hybrid cake, dark and rich, finished with orange and black decorating details.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1 3/4 cups (350g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (45g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 cup (240g) pumpkin puree
- 1/2 cup (120ml) vegetable oil
- 2 large eggs
- 1/2 cup (120ml) buttermilk
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/4 tsp ground cloves

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, cocoa, baking soda, salt, and spices together.
3. Whisk the oil, sugar, eggs, and pumpkin puree together, then alternate adding the flour mixture and buttermilk.
4. Divide between the pans and bake 30-34 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
5. Cool completely, then frost with chocolate buttercream tinted or piped with orange and black decorating details.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

PART 6

# Elegant Party Cakes

Eight more refined cakes for formal parties, anniversaries, and milestone occasions, including a tiered dowel-supported design.

## Naked Vanilla Berry Celebration Cake

*A tall three-layer cake with a thin, barely-there frosting coat that lets the layers show, finished with fresh berries.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • THREE 8-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 14-16 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/2 cups (500g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour three 8-inch pans.
2. Make the vanilla batter as in the standard recipe and divide among the pans.
3. Bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean. Cool completely.
4. Stack the layers with a generous filling of vanilla buttercream between each, but apply only a very thin, scraped-back coat on the outside, letting the cake layers peek through.
5. Top with a pile of fresh mixed berries and a few edible flowers if desired.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 3 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

## Champagne Celebration Cake

*A delicate cake made with reduced champagne or sparkling wine, for anniversaries and milestone toasts.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) cake flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 6 large egg whites
- 1 cup (240ml) champagne or sparkling wine, reduced to 3/4 cup over low heat and cooled
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy. In a separate bowl, whisk the egg whites with the cooled reduced champagne.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and the egg-white mixture.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with champagne buttercream (substitute 2 tbsp of the reduced champagne for liquid in vanilla buttercream).

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy; contains alcohol (cooked, but not fully evaporated).

# Lavender Earl Grey Celebration Cake

*A subtly floral, tea-infused cake for a refined afternoon celebration.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk, steeped with 2 Earl Grey tea bags and cooled
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp dried culinary lavender, finely ground

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Warm the milk with the tea bags, steep 10 minutes, then remove the bags and cool completely.
3. Whisk the flour, baking powder, salt, and ground lavender together.
4. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time.
5. Alternate adding the flour mixture and the cooled tea-infused milk.
6. Divide between the pans and bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
7. Cool completely, then frost with vanilla or honey buttercream.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Pistachio Rose Celebration Cake

*Ground pistachios folded into the batter, with a delicate rosewater buttercream, for an elegant dessert table.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/2 cups (310g) all-purpose flour
- 1 cup (120g) finely ground pistachios
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/2 tsp rosewater (in the batter, optional)

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, ground pistachios, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the rosewater if using.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and milk.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with rosewater buttercream (start with 1/4 tsp rosewater per batch — it's potent) and garnish with chopped pistachios.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and pistachios.

# Tiered Vanilla Wedding-Style Cake

*A two-tier celebration cake using dowel support, suited to anniversaries, engagements, or formal parties.*

PREP 45 MIN • BAKE 28-32 MIN PER TIER • ONE 9-INCH ROUND PAN, ONE 6-INCH ROUND PAN • 350F/175C • 30-35 SERVINGS

- 1.5 batches vanilla cake batter (see Classic Birthday Vanilla recipe, scaled up)
- 2 batches vanilla buttercream (see Decorating Handbook)
- 6-8 wooden or plastic cake dowels
- 1 cake board sized to the 6-inch tier

### METHOD

1. Bake two 9-inch layers and two 6-inch layers from the scaled-up batter, following the standard vanilla cake method. Cool completely.
2. Level, fill, and frost each tier separately on its own cake board, chilling each until firm.
3. Insert 4-5 dowels evenly spaced into the 9-inch bottom tier, trimmed level with the frosted surface.
4. Center the 6-inch top tier (on its board) on top of the bottom tier, resting on the dowels.
5. Smooth any seams where the tiers meet, and add a final decorative border if desired.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 3 days; bring to room temperature 30-45 minutes before serving.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Honey Almond Celebration Cake

*A moist cake sweetened partly with honey, with ground almonds for texture, finished with honey buttercream.*

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

- 2 1/2 cups (310g) all-purpose flour
- 1 cup (120g) finely ground almonds
- 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (170g) honey
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 4 large eggs
- 1 cup (240ml) whole milk
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Grease and flour two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk the flour, ground almonds, baking powder, and salt together.
3. Beat the butter, sugar, and honey until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time.
4. Alternate adding the flour mixture and milk.
5. Divide between the pans and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
6. Cool completely, then frost with honey buttercream (beat 2 tbsp honey into a batch of vanilla buttercream) and garnish with sliced almonds.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and almonds.

## Elegant Ombre Celebration Cake

*A single-flavor cake frosted in a graduated color wash, from deep at the base to pale at the top.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • THREE 8-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 14-16 SERVINGS

- 1 batch white or vanilla cake batter, baked in three 8-inch layers
- 1.5 batches vanilla buttercream, divided into 3 bowls and tinted in 3 shades of the same color

### METHOD

1. Bake and cool the three cake layers as directed in the standard recipe.
2. Stack and fill the layers with the lightest shade of buttercream.
3. Apply the darkest shade around the bottom third of the cake's exterior, the medium shade around the middle third, and the lightest shade around the top third.
4. Using a bench scraper, smooth around the whole cake in one continuous motion so the colors blend softly at the transitions.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

# Dark Chocolate Salted Caramel Celebration Cake

*A dramatic dark chocolate cake with salted caramel drips, suited as a centerpiece dessert for a formal party.*

PREP 30 MIN • BAKE 30-34 MIN • TWO 9-INCH ROUND PANS • 350F/175C • 12-14 SERVINGS

### CAKE

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (65g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 1/4 tsp baking soda
- 1 1/8 tsp baking powder
- 1 1/8 tsp salt
- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) buttermilk
- 9 tbsp (135ml) vegetable oil
- 1 cup plus 2 tbsp (270ml) hot coffee

### DRIP & GARNISH

- 1/2 cup prepared salted caramel sauce, slightly warmed
- Flaky sea salt, for garnish

### METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Bake the chocolate cake batter in two 9-inch pans as directed, 30-34 minutes. Cool completely.
2. Frost with chocolate ganache or buttercream and chill 20 minutes until firm.
3. Spoon the slightly warmed caramel around the top edge, letting it drip down the sides.
4. Finish with a sprinkle of flaky sea salt over the top.

**Storage:** Refrigerate up to 4 days.

**Allergens:** Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

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